

Lloyd's Register Foundation

CEO Report

June 2026



Foundation



Introduction

This quarter we completed our all colleague 'view' survey to get systematic feedback on how we work together as a Foundation. Our results, including in the headline engagement scores, are strong and show year on year improvements. However, we are committed to continuous improvement and there are several areas where we know we can do better. We are looking forward to our all colleague away day in July to gain more detailed feedback and ideas for action. We are also planning a development programme for all colleagues for the coming year.

Highlights

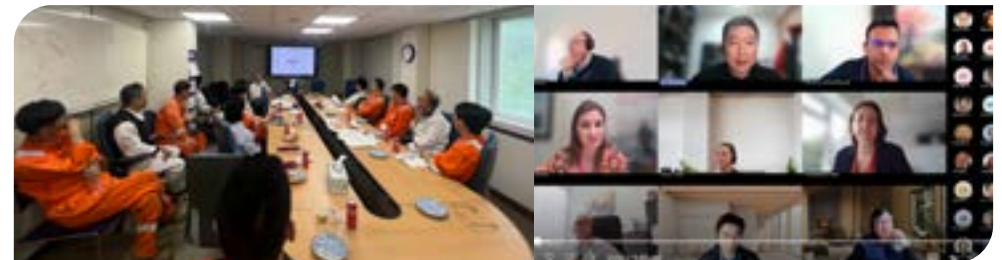
- We have been able to share the news that Matthias will be joining the Board of Trustees as Chair-elect. Colleagues are looking forward to getting to know him and are contributing ideas to an induction programme for the coming year. 2027 marks the Foundation's 15th birthday, the midway point in our strategy, and the opportunity to recognise Thomas as the founding Chair of Lloyd's Register Foundation. We will be developing and setting out plans to recognise these great milestones at our all colleague away day in July.



- We submitted written evidence from our World Risk Poll to the UK House of Lords enquiry into national resilience and disaster preparedness and we were subsequently invited to attend to give further oral evidence. Nancy Hey represented the Foundation and did an excellent job responding to questions and providing evidence-based insights. You can watch the session [here](#).



- We have continued to raise awareness of the Foundation's work among LR Group colleagues by creating more opportunities for engagement, including themed presentations, tailored content, regular interactions, visits to local LR offices and tours of the LR Building. To date, approximately 875 LR colleagues have been reached directly through 24 engagement sessions, with almost 100 colleagues also attending Heritage-led building tours. Encouragingly, this continued focus on visibility and understanding of the Foundation has been reflected in LR colleagues' feedback. In the recent LR Group View Survey, the score for the Foundation-related question: "I understand the role of the Lloyd's Register Foundation and how my work at Lloyd's Register contributes success" increased from 66 in February 2025 to 69 in March 2026.



Lowlights

- We had our first experience of our Grants system being 'Phished' by AI. Our controls easily picked up this incident, but it does highlight the vigilance we need to respond to new risks.
- Two valued colleagues have let us know of their plans to leave the Foundation over the coming six months. We are a small organisation with low turnover and losing colleagues is deeply felt. Turnover is also an opportunity to consider how we deliver, and we will be working on our recruitment strategies to bring in the skills we need.

Things to watch

- As I write this report, I am in Mombasa in Kenya to contribute to the Our Ocean Conference. This is a UN conference bringing together commitments across the ocean economy. Our Ocean Centre programme is gaining visibility as a globally leading programme making a difference to economic development and I have been meeting lots of local stakeholders while I am here. I look forward to sharing more about our trip when I return.



- Our Ocean Centres partnership with the UNGC and their local networks is maturing well, and we have received the reports from phase 1. There has been a huge amount of work and insight developed through the in-country workshops convening stakeholders around our safety mission. We are learning a lot about ourselves and how to deliver against a locally led agenda, and this programme continues to evolve. It is not a static programme though: we will be making decisions in the coming year on how to bring on new Centres (there has been lots of interest) and where we may need to pause or stop work.
- Following the input from Trustees at our away day in February, we commissioned a short video to explain – drawn from the away day – what we mean when we talk about safety and our mission to engineer a safer world. We plan to launch this video externally later in the summer. Watch the video here (add link). We are also in the final stages of developing content for our 'Voices' campaign, which will share 20 impactful stories through video, written content, and photography, covering the five areas of our strategy, across multiple continents. This content will be used by our partners around the world to raise awareness and influence others towards our safety mission.



- We continue to see positive media coverage about the Foundation's work. View our coverage book to see some of the highlights and read the articles via this link: [Quarter Four Coverage Highlights / CoverageBook](#)
- I occasionally get approached to talk at conferences or contribute my experiences in various ways. During the last quarter, I taught on the master's course in Construction Engineering at Cambridge University; spent an evening 'in conversation with' the students on the Oxford University Said Business School Masters in Business Leadership course; and I took part in The Purposeful Strategist, podcast with Menkus & Associates, where I spoke about how we developed the Foundation's Strategy.

Operations

People

This quarter, Foundation colleagues attended the first Foundation development day of 2026 in the Lloyd's Register Building. The day provided colleagues with the opportunity to learn about the work of the International Maritime Rescue Federation, gain insights into the evolution of grant giving at the Foundation, hear about the range of major projects undertaken by the LR Global Projects Team. Plus gain an understanding of the principles of grant contracting and hear an update on progress against the Foundation's current business plan.

Throughout March, Foundation colleagues met with their line managers to discuss their development and progress against their personal goals for 25/26 as part of the performance development process.

During the last quarter, Foundation colleagues had the opportunity to attend development activities including;

- A presentation on findings of the Foresight Review: Safe adoption of AI
- A presentation giving an overview of the Lloyd's Register Maritime Decarbonisation Hub strategy
- A Lunch & Learn on the Foundation's World Risk Poll data explorer
- Additional bespoke mandatory GDPR training provided by the Group legal team covering principles of data protection management
- Bespoke training on the use of Microsoft CoPilot in excel and using agents & automation
- A presentation on the work of the LR Group Maritime Product team

- A Lunch & Learn with Professor Lelanie Smith from the University of Pretoria on the Systemic Transformation of Engineering Education for Safety and Sustainability
- A presentation on the Cultural Heritage Framework Programme
- An update on the Vision Zero Fund 10-year anniversary event
- A presentation on the Partnership for Learning and Skills to Advance Safer Engineering in East Africa project

We have recently welcomed Chizoba Oparah into the new role of Evidence Reviewer as part of the development of the Global Safety Evidence Centre and welcomed Esther Alonge to the Foundation as a temporary Grants Administrator to provide additional support to the team.



Chizoba Oparah



Esther Alonge

As well as working together, we have also celebrated three weddings, an engagement and many 'big' birthdays this quarter!

The team continues to work well in a hybrid way in the new building, and the new events programme is being delivered successfully. The transfer of the building from LRG to LRF is now expected to be in September / October 2026.

Risk

The Foundation's Risk Register is regularly updated to reflect our iterative approach to risk management, with internal and external risks actively monitored by the leadership team. Risk management is handled in-house and supported by a three-lines-of-defence model, which is continuously refined to ensure effective mitigation and operational control. BDO provides third-line assurance through independent internal audit. As part of this approach, a risk deep-dive paper is prepared for each Trustee Board meeting. At the June 2026 meeting, the focus is on Risk 15 – Artificial Intelligence. Since the last Committee meeting, BDO and the Foundation have held annual planning discussions, including the planned internal audit scopes for Grant-Giving Processes and the Heritage Archive.

Grant funding

We have worked with the GDCA Chair and members to evolve our GDCA agenda and the way we provide information, with a successful trial of the new agenda at the June GDCA meeting.

Over the last three months, £6.63m has been committed in grant funding, with the majority awarded through open calls. Key programmes – Maritime Connected, GSEC, and Heritage – have now concluded, demonstrating strong demand and competitive selection.

- Maritime Connected: 103 applications were received, with 85 progressing to full review. Nine grants were approved, totalling £451k.
- GSEC: 198 expressions of interest were submitted, with 23 organisations invited to full proposal stage. Eight grants were approved, totalling £1.69m.
- Heritage: 27 organisations were invited to submit full proposals, resulting in eight approved grants with a total value of £2.5m.

In addition, two further applications under the previously closed Engineering a Safer World call have been approved following additional development:

- CivicDataLab (£850k): Coastal Resilience Data Collaborative, strengthening climate resilience across India through enhanced data integration and decision-making.
- University of Southampton (£330k): Safe and Just Transition in Domestic Shipping, developing decarbonisation pathways for maritime systems in developing economies.

Targeted (directed) funding has also supported three strategic initiatives:

- International Coalition for Sustainable Infrastructure (£533k): Advancing a global Nature-Positive Engineering programme.
- Institution of Occupational Safety and Health (£110k): Pilot to strengthen national occupational safety and health systems via development bank collaboration.
- Engineering Professors' Council (£250k): Development of a global toolkit to embed safety in engineering education.

Alongside new awards, variations to existing grant agreements have been approved to support ongoing programme delivery. Additional awards have also been made through the rolling Partner for Purpose and NEST calls.

Separately, DCA approvals total £1.87m, covering:

- £40k for digitisation of historical shipping registers
- £200k for the IMO sponsorship agreement
- £1.63m for the 2026/27 Strategic Communications budget

Overall, delivery remains strong, with high levels of demand across programmes and continued alignment to strategic priorities.

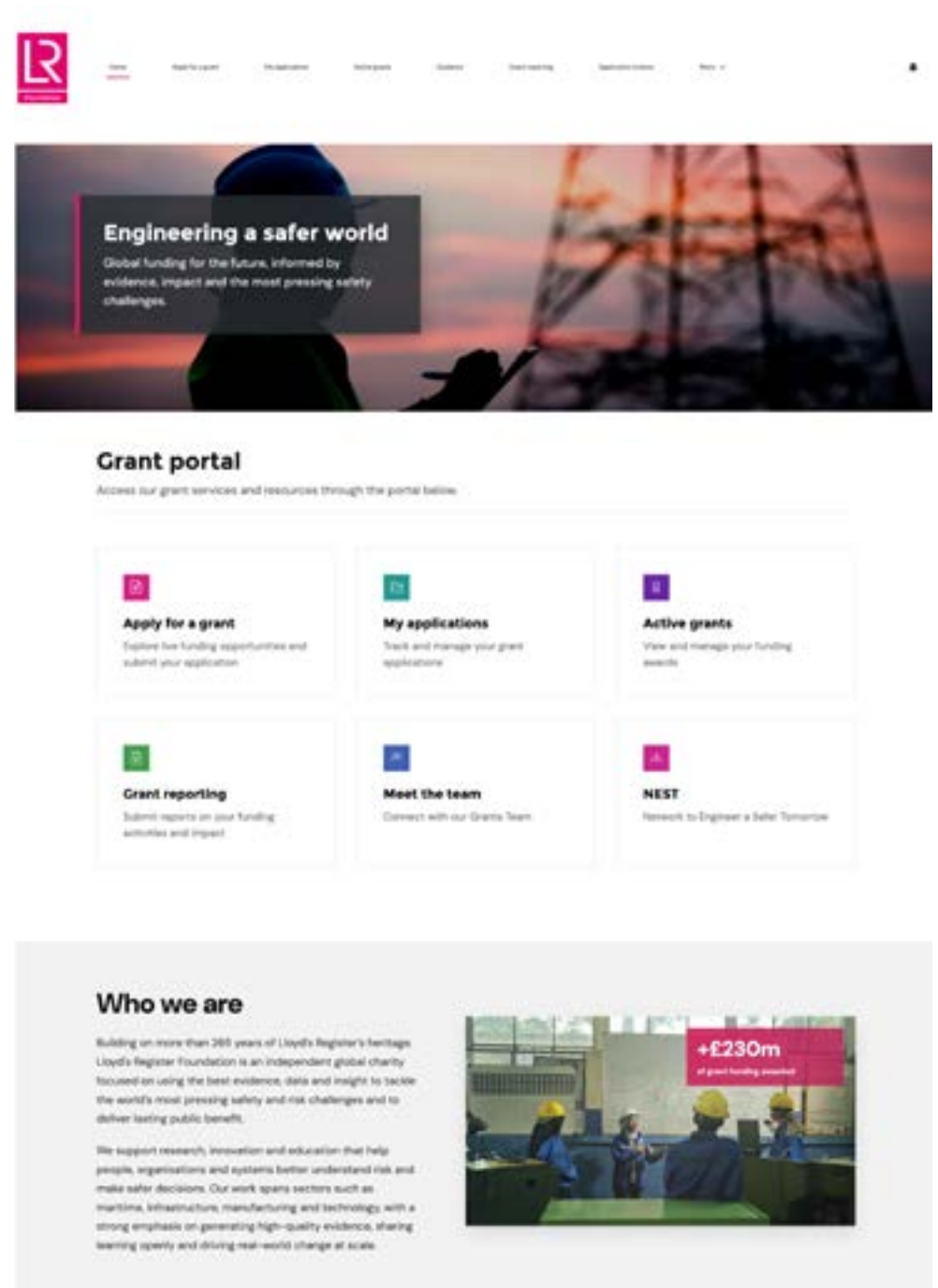
Digital development

The Foundation's digital transformation work has continued at pace, with several major systems now reaching launch or final delivery stages. This includes the launch of our new bespoke Heritage Centre website and digital collection architecture, final preparation for Salesforce as our new grant management system and Experience Cloud grants portal, development of the Global Safety Evidence Centre (GSEC) bespoke portal, ongoing improvements to website data visualisation, and the introduction of governance and guidance around the use of AI.

Work is also ongoing to develop a new data visualisation suite for the Foundation's website, alongside the GSEC portal. The GSEC site will bring together evidence, datasets, research and programme content across Safe Work and Safety Science, supported by clear navigation and integration with wider Foundation activity.

Final preparation is also underway for the launch of Salesforce Nonprofit Cloud's Grant Management functionality on 1 July, alongside a brand-new Experience Cloud grants portal for external applicants and grant holders. This represents a major operational milestone as the Foundation moves to a new grant management platform for the first time. All existing grant data has been transferred to the new platform and from launch, all new applications will be managed through Salesforce. Flexigrant will remain live until December 2026 as a contingency.

Significant preparation has been completed to support this transition, including the creation and enrichment of application records, reviews, organisational data, funding opportunities and live grants. This will provide a clearer and more consistent view of funding activity, strengthen governance and improve reporting against the Foundation's strategy. The system launching on 1 July will be a strong minimum viable product, with further refinement expected as it embeds into day-to-day operations.



AI continues to be a fast-evolving area of both opportunity and risk. The Foundation has developed formal guidance for external applicants and grant holders, which is currently under review by Group Legal and is expected to be in place ahead of the Salesforce launch. This guidance sets clear expectations for responsible and transparent use of AI, while retaining human review and decision-making. AI is also being used selectively to support internal processes, and increased AI-driven traffic across websites is being monitored. A new Copilot agent, Sentinel, is supporting review processes by indicating the likelihood of AI-generated or assisted content, while maintaining human judgement as the primary control.

The new Heritage Centre website represents a significant step forward in how we preserve, manage and share the Foundation's heritage collections. The site now provides access to over 1.2 million pages and has been viewed in 187 countries worldwide, extending the reach and accessibility of the Foundation's archive, library and object collections. Early performance data indicates a clear shift in user behaviour, with significantly stronger engagement compared with the previous website.

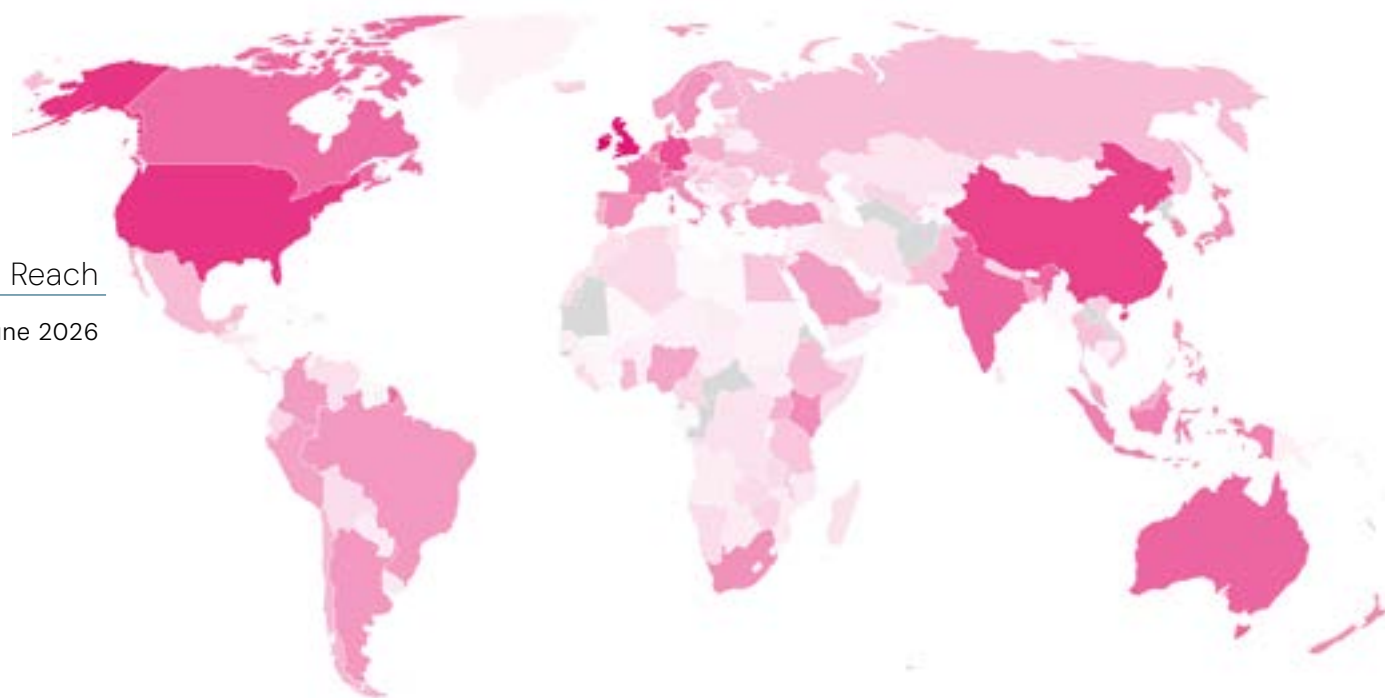
Impact Highlight

Recent analytics data show the new Heritage Centre website delivered significantly deeper engagement than the previous site, with views up 115%, views per user up 347%, and engagement time up 327%. This demonstrates that users are exploring more content and spending substantially longer interacting with the Foundation's heritage collections.

We are now approaching the end of the three-year Digital Transformation Project signed off by the Board in May 2023 and we will provide a comprehensive update at a future Board meeting.

Heritage Centre website Global Reach

Active users by country, 15th April – 1st June 2026



Safer Maritime Systems

People, Programmes and Delivery

A partnership between the International Maritime Rescue Federation (IMRF) and Climate Adaptation Works Ltd delivered a global survey on the climate readiness of maritime search and rescue (SAR) organisations, drawing responses from over 20 countries. The findings informed the development of two practical tools to help SAR organisations assess climate risks and prioritise adaptation actions. These tools are now being positioned for use within funding proposals, policy agendas and donor strategies, while also supporting local strategic planning on climate risk and operational readiness.

Our Maritime Connected call has shown a clear need for maritime workers and organisations to come together to share common challenges and practical ways to improve safety. The call received 104 applications, with eight funded across Canada, India, Kenya, Malaysia, New Zealand, Tanzania and the UK, covering areas such as shipbreaking, remote pilotage, climate risks for ports, seafarer wellbeing, and how better coordination and shared approaches can improve safety across the system.

The Voyage Solutions project is showing how practical onboard tools can improve seafarer wellbeing and safety. A Voyage Guide prototype for ice navigation and deck officer competency has been developed, approved for vessel use and technically validated. Early evidence shows potential for wider application across safety critical shipboard operations, with growing interest from equipment manufacturers and vessel operators in providing guidance at the point of work to reduce human error. In response to an identified gap, the team also developed "Voyage Ice", a web-based tool providing real-time ice observations and risk alerts, which will be demonstrated to the polar maritime community.

The UN Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)-led work on global guidelines for inspection and valuation of small-scale fishing vessels has built on £163k of Foundation funding to secure £300k in additional cash and £100k in in-kind contributions. Implementation is already secured in Saint Lucia and Saint Vincent

and the Grenadines through the Green Climate Fund and Global Environment Facility programmes, with further uptake expected in Tanzania. Endorsement by International Maritime Organization and FAO will support integration into global fisheries frameworks and enable adoption by member states.

The Royal College of Art (RCA), in partnership with Hawkshill Consulting and the International Organization for Marine Aids to Navigation (IALA), has launched a three-year, £1.1m initiative funded by Lloyd's Register Foundation and IFAN to improve maritime safety in Small Island Developing States and Least Developed Countries. The project focuses on developing low-cost aids to navigation (AtoN), addressing barriers created by the cost and complexity of existing systems. Through a co-design approach, it will work with local communities to develop solutions that can be built and maintained using locally available materials and skills, supporting more accessible safety infrastructure in underserved waterways.

Comms and engagement

Our fishing film "All that separates us is distance" has been used to engage high-level policy and sector audiences. It was screened at the ILO-European Commission high-level launch event in Brussels in March, following the launch of the Partnership for Decent Work in Fisheries, which brought together governments, the European Commission, the ILO, and wider partners. This provided early visibility within an influential policy audience and helped reinforce the human impact underpinning the Work in Fishing Convention (C188). The film has also received media coverage, appearing in key fishing and maritime publications.

In May the film was used to prompt discussion at a curated, invite-only event in Indonesia involving government, civil society, industry and international partners against the backdrop of the country's ratification of C188. The film helped ground discussion in lived experience and supported more practical conversations on safety, working conditions and livelihoods. Media also attended. During the visit to Indonesia Olivia Swift and Alan McCulla also met with the Ocean Centres Indonesia team and discussed several matters around fisher and maritime safety.

<https://voi.id/berita/573866/all-that-separates-us-is-distance-dokumenter->

tentang-pahit-manis-kehidupan-nelayan

We've awarded over £500k for a two-year initiative to strengthen corporate accountability across ocean industries. Led by Lancaster University Management School with international partners, the project will develop a practical reporting and accountability toolkit tailored to the ocean economy, focusing on worker protection, community impact and human rights due diligence. It aims to establish clearer expectations and support more consistent safety and social performance across complex maritime sectors. Specialist media publications picked up the story: <https://www.marinelink.com/news/lloyds-register-foundation-tackle-539215> <https://nationalpreparednesscommission.uk/news/lloyds-register-foundation-project-to-transform-accountability-across-ocean-industries/>

Skilled People for Safer Engineering

People, Programmes and Delivery

Moi University has advanced from project set-up to evidence generation and stakeholder validation, aligning industry and institutional priorities to shape training modules that address real-world skills needs. A skills needs assessment for the Partnership for Learning & Skills to Advance Safer Engineering in East Africa project has identified critical skills gaps in cyber-physical systems, digitalisation, AI integration, and future fuel handling. These findings on technical, safety, and digital competencies will support the project's development of curriculum for engineering students. The university presented the project at the Engineering Partnership Convention in Mombasa, Kenya held in April 2026 and will present the findings from the skills needs assessment report at the UNESCO 10th Africa Engineering Conference in September 2026, in Dar es Salaam, Tanzania.

Ms. Adi Salaseini Muavesi Lesianawai, a Senior Standard and Conformance Officer at the Maritime Safety Authority of Fiji and Foundation-sponsored IMLI Fellow, has been selected as the Valedictorian for the Class of 2026. She was chosen

as a valedictorian out of 56 students for her excellent performance, diligence, and integrity. She is adamant in returning to Fiji and serve her country, "regional organisations pay much more, but my country needs experts".

The Vice Chancellor and Principal, University of Pretoria, Prof. Francis Petersen met with our skills leads and I to discuss strengthening our existing grant relationship as well as looking to the future – addressing critical safety challenges at the point of most need in South Africa and surrounding territories.

Under the Engineering a Safer World Funding Call, Helvetas Swiss Intercooperation in partnership with TRAC4Change, Nepal have begun implementation engagements to strengthen government capacity, build partnerships, and explore funding pipelines for trail bridge delivery in Tanzania, laying foundations for safer, climate resilient infrastructure and improved access for remote communities.

Together with IOSH, the Foundation ran an Informal Workers Safety and Health Roundtable, with a diverse range of stakeholders, including multilateral organisations, charities, researchers, and academics. The event highlighted a need for more work on convening conversations across the different stakeholders (including ensuring workers' voices are central to the conversation), creating communities of practice, leveraging standards, and producing more evidence on what works to improve informal worker safety. The event marks some of the initial work for the Foundation's focus on this area. Further grants on informal workers in construction are currently being explored.

Comms and engagement

In April, the Foundation hosted a private screening and drinks reception at the IMO. Attended by Secretary-General Arsenio Dominguez and over 200 country representatives to the IMO Legal Committee, we had the opportunity to share an eight-part, global interview series highlighting the careers of former Lloyd's Register Foundation-funded graduates to the IMO's International Maritime Law Institute (IMLI) and the impact these graduates have made to safety in their countries.

In collaboration with our strategic partners the Alan Turing Institute and the Royal

Academy of Engineering, we have published 'Data-centric engineering and AI skills for engineers', a report that examines how data-centric engineering skills are being integrated into engineering programmes across UK higher education, as well as how they can be strengthened and scaled to meet future demand. The report also offers new curriculum guidance for engineering education across the country.

The Foundation featured prevalently throughout LR's Skills and Education Day at Posidonia this year, highlighting our work with HELMEPA, WMU, Nautical Institute and LR Group, and exploring why investing in skills, training and education will be critical as the maritime industry navigates the transition to new fuels, digital technologies and AI.

Safer, Sustainable Infrastructure

People, Programme and Delivery

Internodos, an initiative established by social innovation laboratory Movilizadorio and Engineering X's Safer Complex Systems programme, held its first workshop in Bogota this quarter. It convened a diverse international community of around 60 stakeholders, translating systems thinking into prioritised missions with the goal of strengthening collaboration, innovation, and coordinated action to safely decarbonise Colombia's energy ecosystem.

This quarter, Engineering X's Safer End of Engineered Life programme have established an Offshore Wind End-of-Life Committee to work on regulation and standards for decommissioning wind turbines and leveraged an additional £95,700 in funding for a forthcoming report on the High-level review of the end of life of photovoltaic infrastructure in low and middle-income countries.

The Data-Centric Engineering (DCE) programme by Cambridge University Press, an open access, interdisciplinary engineering journal founded through Foundation funding, has shifted from grant dependence to financial self-sufficiency, enabling continued open access and advocacy beyond the funding period.

To date, the Centre for Assuring Autonomy has secured £21.4 million in additional

funding, representing 537% uplift on the grant from the Foundation, demonstrating exceptional leverage alongside clear pathways to safer autonomous systems, improved patient safety and stronger AI governance.

This quarter, a £50,000 collaborative small grant awarded to University of Wolverhampton and Moi University in Kenya has concluded. During this time, they have published an academic publication, professional dialogue and future funding opportunities, demonstrating how a relatively small grant can generate meaningful international impact and lay the groundwork for longer-term change.

A collaboration workshop held in March between WWF, International Coalition for Sustainable Infrastructure, the Foundation and FIDIC has been instrumental in shaping a forthcoming programme on Nature Positive Engineering (NPE), focused on developing an evidence framework for NPE and engineering education curriculum.

Comms and engagement

This quarter, The Global Initiative for Industrial Safety (GIFIS), released a new white paper to help improve how organisations identify and adopt technologies for industrial safety. "Making safety tech work: A practical framework for identifying and selecting safety technology solutions for industry" tackles a critical industry challenge: despite rapid advances in safety technologies, adoption remains limited due to unclear evidence around their effectiveness and value.

In May, experts from across the maritime industry joined us in the Lloyd's Register Building to examine how AI, sustainability and gender equity can reshape the future of maritime employment. In collaboration with the Alan Turing Institute, we explored how emerging digital skills and AI-enabled practices are creating new forms of employment and present an opportunity to build a more inclusive workforce.

'Future-Proofing Ports: Nature, Climate and People as Drivers of Competitiveness', the new Briefing Paper published this quarter by the World Economic Forum's ACT Ports initiative and the Foundation, shows how ports can mitigate climate, nature and people-related risks, whilst strengthening cross-ecosystem collaboration for a safer, more prosperous sector.

AEGIS, our grant with the National Technical University of Athens (NTUA), was officially launched at the LR stand during Posidonia and was well attended by a strong number of Greek maritime stakeholders.

Resilience4Ports application to host a side event at the Our Ocean conference Kenya was accepted. Selected as one of 346 high-profile applicants for just 40 available slots, this represents a significant achievement for the initiative.

Evidence and insight

People, Programmes, and Delivery

In May, we celebrated the Lloyd's Register Foundation Global Safety Evidence Centre's first birthday. Thanks to website analysis, we know that within the first year, over 100,000 people from 197 countries and territories have used the Global Safety Evidence Centre hub. Of over 7,000 report downloads, the most loved evidence has been the:

- Role of Leadership and Governance in Occupational Safety and Health report, produced with the International Organization for Standardization
- World Risk Poll Resilience 2024 Report: Resilience in a Changing World
- World Risk Poll Data Explorer, used by over 35,000 people.

All eight successful applicants selected from the first GSEC funding call have now been approved at GAM – a key Foundation Milestone. These projects will now proceed to the pre-contracting stage.

Research Outputs:

World Risk Poll 2024 Focus On: Migration in a warming world. This report, published in May, uses data from the 2019–2023 World Risk Polls, combined with the Gallup World Poll question on willingness to migrate, to examine the link between climate

and migration.

Protecting the Mental Health of Disaster First Responders: A Systematic Review. A call for evidence has been launched for one of the Centre's latest grant-funded research programmes, run by The Society of Occupational Medicine.

World Risk Poll:

Wave 4 of the World Risk Poll is complete, with the first report examining the findings to launch during London Climate Action Week on 23 June.

Development for a new module of questions on energy and electricity infrastructure in Wave 5 has progressed, with cognitive testing going out to five countries in June. These new questions will work alongside the core safety and risk questions, and the Resilience Index. A final decision on the questions for inclusion in Wave 5 will be made in the autumn.

World Risk Poll into Action Grants:

The World Risk Poll into Action funding programme continues to demonstrate how perception-based data can drive tangible improvements in safety and resilience on the ground. Major milestones include:

Pakistan formerly adopted the ILO Code of Practice on Safety and Health in Construction as national law, a direct impact of work to improve the engineering of integrated safety systems by BWI.

GNDR in Ethiopia and Nepal are working to advance localised early warning systems for landslides, with community level research already involving over 400 households in Ethiopia.

In Laos and Salvador, the Resilient Cities programme has produced a robust comparative analysis linking Poll perception data with formal resilience metrics.

Several projects using Poll data have concluded recently:

A two-year grant to the Catanduanes State University in the Philippines has significantly enhanced evidence-based comprehension of disaster risk and

resilience across all participating sites (26 barangays) of Pandan, Catanduanes.

In Nairobi, Data4Change has filled critical gaps in data systems, to make informal workers visible. The community-led data initiative in Nairobi's informal settlements of Mathare and Dandora has adopted Poll indicators into a community-based methodology.

The 2.5 year DARAJA project led by Resurgence has leveraged the Poll dataset to support urban community climate resilience in Uganda, Kenya and Tanzania, so that climate-vulnerable urban communities can better anticipate, understand and take action against weather related risks.

Comms and engagement

Work to build our networks with other relevant NGOs and establish GSEC's profile as a leading evidence centre continues to build momentum. Nancy Hey attended the Philanthropy and Research Centres: Models, Challenges and Opportunities workshop, held in Barcelona at the end of March, and contributed to IOSH's panel discussion at the Health & Safety Event in Birmingham in April on 'The use of Evidence in OSH'.

Dr Elizabeth Kumah presented on our ongoing 'Effectiveness of Disaster Early Warning Systems' Evidence Review at the Gulf Coast and Caribbean State of the Science 10th Anniversary meeting. Elizabeth also contributed to a panel discussion on Communication for Weather Risk Reduction held in London by the Leeds University Business School.

Dr Aaron Gardner and Dr Emily Lambe presented World Risk Poll workplace harm data at the first webinar in a planned series on OSH statistics run by the ILO. Emily is part of the ILO's working group to update OSH statistics and standards over the next few years.

In May, Emily presented recent and future GSEC work at in Baltimore as part of the Safety On The Edge 2026 conference. The aim of the conference is to discuss new and emerging safety issues with industry leaders, safety professionals, and researchers.

Heritage

People, Programmes and Delivery

In March we hosted the Annual Heritage Stakeholder Day at the Lloyd's Register Building. It was a true 'heritage takeover' with grantee talks, tours, research workshops, and archive showcases in the library.

In May we hosted 'A celebration of Women's progress in maritime life: past, present, future', one of a series of three events in the Lloyd's Register Building during 'Women in Maritime' week.

The heritage team has also been stepping up the Foundation's engagement in the Caribbean – specifically, Jamaica throughout this quarter. Louise Sanger represented the Foundation at the 57th Annual Conference of the Association of Caribbean Historians, held in Kingston, Jamaica in May. The event brought together a rich mix of scholars, heritage practitioners and others to discuss the maritime history and legacies of slavery in the Caribbean. Connected to the event was the launch of the National Archives' Foundation-funded PASSAGE research programme at the British High Commission, where Louise gave the opening remarks. She was then invited to talk about the grant on the Talking History programme on Nationwide Radio Jamaica.

While there, Louise also supported UNESCO and the Government of Jamaica's three-day stakeholder workshop in Kingston and Port Royal, which focused on advancing the protection and awareness of underwater cultural heritage.

Alex Stitt was in the Faroe Islands at the UArctic Congress in May where five UArctic x Foundation research fellows presented their work on various aspects of Arctic maritime safety. Their work will conclude at the end of this year, with each invited to present their findings at the IMO.

Following a rigorous selection process that began in September 2025, eight grants have been awarded from our first-ever Heritage Grant Open Call, with a total budget of £2.5 million. The awarded projects reflect a rich global diversity, spanning

topics from shipwrecks in East Africa to research uncovering Arctic navigation routes and knowledge systems. We are currently in the pre-contracting stage, with details to follow.

Lloyd's Register Foundation and University of Portsmouth PhD recipient, Corey Watson has finished and shared his thesis on 'Lloyd's Register Surveyors in China, 1869– 1935'.

The Sail to Steam, Carbon to Green programme has selected its second studentship. They will be focusing on the port city of Mombasa, Kenya.

The Global Maritime Histories Grant continues to go from strength to strength; ten projects have been accepted following the call in October 2025, representing organisations from 16 countries. Louise Sanger joined Kristen Greenaway, President of ICMM, to officially sign the contract for the next phase of the Global Maritime Histories programme.

Comms and engagement

The new Heritage Centre website launched in April, including an upgraded search system for our archive records, transforming how users can use and engage with the material.

The SHE_SEES exhibition at Portsmouth Historic Quarter continues to receive visitors, as well as praise for bringing to light opportunities for women in maritime. In a major step for the international phase, a digital exhibition for SHE-SEES India was launched soon after the Heritage Centre website went live. The portraits and interviews from 33 women across India's maritime industry is celebrating the country's leading female change-makers.

Our half-model of Brunel's SS Great Britain is to go on loan to the SS Great Britain Trust, a fitting partnership that was celebrated during an evening at the Lloyd's Register Building in April with a talk from the Brunel Institute on 'Risk and Innovation: Brunel, Shipping and London'.

This academic year we have welcomed nine delegations of students and academic staff from Universities in Spain, Belgium, Germany, and Greece, totalling 270

visitors, and between March and May the team completed 24 tours for a further 138 visitors.

Collections Management

In April the team began a five-month project to create an Operations Manual, working with Collections Management Consultant Marion Crick. The work will create and standardise 23 core procedures, strengthening our management systems, and support the upcoming collections move back to, and reopening of service, in the Lloyd's Register Building.

The draft Collections Access policy – the final piece of governance – has been finalised, a key part of our journey to accreditation.

Work continues on the project to extract and normalise data from the Register of Ships books, using the AI-powered OCR 2 CSV programme. The team have been working on the registers between 1835 and 1935/6; cross-checking inventories, scanning missing volumes, and running treated files through optical character recognition software for external suppliers. This time-intensive work ensures the project will have the complete set of statistical data required for advancing research.

11 ship models have been shipped off to specialist repair and cleaning studios. These are just some of the Centre's extensive collection of models, which range from an oil rig platform to a late 18th century ship of bone ivory. Displays are being created to bring more of these models into the Lloyd's Register Building.

Upcoming events

We have series of events in the Lloyd's Register Building during London Climate Action Week:

Tuesday 23 June:

- World Risk Poll 2026 launch: global attitudes to climate risk (hybrid) – 14.30 – 17.00
- Central Banks Roundtable (hybrid) – UNGC – 15.00 – 16.30
- Ocean Night hosted by Lloyd's Register Foundation and UN Global Compact (in person) – 18.00 – 21.00

Wednesday 24 June:

- The Future of Ocean Infrastructure: Financing the Backbone of Global Trade (in person) – 10.30 – 12.00

Thursday 25 June – Day of the Seafarer 2026

- Digital skills in maritime education and training: a global deep dive into people, skills and readiness for change – 09.00 – 11.45

Additional upcoming events:

- 7 July – Networking Academic Grant SADIT-MAR London workshop with Yidiz Technical University at the Lloyd's Register Building
- 2-4 September – Safety 2026 in Cape Town, South Africa
- 13-18 September – ICMM Congress 2026 in Sydney, Australia
- September – UNGA / Unstoppable Africa 2026 in New York, US

